DESSERT · MICROWAVE

Microwave Applesauce

Makes about 3 cups · 10 min prep · 15 min microwave

INGREDIENTS

4	Honeycrisp apples
1 cup	water
½ cup	sugar
½ tsp	cinnamon
	Juice of ½ lemon

METHOD

1. Peel and core the apples. Quarter each one, then cut each quarter crosswise about five times — more or fewer depending on how big the apple is. You want small, even pieces.
2. Put everything in a microwave-safe casserole dish: apples, water, sugar, cinnamon, lemon juice. Stir until every piece is coated.
3. Microwave 7–8 minutes on high. Stir it all around again.
4. Microwave another 7–8 minutes on high.
5. Mash to the texture you want, and eat.

NOTES

Steam. The dish and the liquid come out very hot. Uncover away from your face and use a towel on the sides.

Texture. Mash lightly for chunky, longer for smooth. If it looks loose, it thickens as it cools.

Sweetness. Honeycrisp are sweet already — the sugar can come down if you like it tart. Taste after the first mash.

Keeping it. Refrigerate up to a week. Good warm or cold.

Other apples. McIntosh and Cortland collapse fastest — check a couple minutes early. Golden Delicious, Fuji, and Gala are sweeter, so cut the sugar to ¼ cup and taste. Granny Smith is firm and tart: full sugar, plus 2–3 extra minutes. Braeburn, Jonagold, and Pink Lady behave like Honeycrisp. A mix of one that falls apart and one that holds gives the best texture.

From your own notes.